encouraging it to be a responsible stakeholder in the international community would be the best way to delay, mitigate, or eliminate that threat.

During this period, both India and the US under Truman and then Eisenhower came to see the other's attitude and actions toward China as, at best, hindering or, at worst, harming their broader strategies. Those attitudes were shaped by their different priorities, geographies, histories, capabilities, commitments, and experiences with China, as well as their differing views of the importance of ideology in shaping Chinese policymakers' decisionmaking. The two countries' differences over perception and approach were evident on questions such as the recognition of China, in the discussions over what to do about Tibet, and in the debate over China's role in the Korean War.

From 1956 to 1962, broad agreement on China was a significant reason for US-India engagement. There was a convergence in the two countries' views on the nature and urgency of the China threat, as well as on the ways and means of dealing with it. Eisenhower in his second term and the Kennedy administration came to see China not just as a direct security threat but also as a symbolic and ideological threat to American interests if it won the development competition. And assertive Chinese behavior caused Indian leaders, like their American counterparts, to see China as a geopolitical threat. The two democracies also agreed on what was required to meet such a threat: close partnership with each other, and the strengthening of India's military and economic capabilities.

During the subsequent phase from 1963 to 1968, American and Indian threat perceptions of China were largely similar, but the two countries' assessment of the ways and means required to tackle the threat once again diverged. Their common interest in containing China kept their disillusionment from resulting in complete disengagement. But while the countries' agreement on ends laid the basis for cooperation, their disagreement on the ways and means to contain China stalled their alignment.

The two countries disagreed about the optimum balance of resources that should be devoted toward Indian development versus defense to strengthen the country against China. In a role reversal, the US, led by Lyndon Johnson, believed that the China threat called for more Indian investment in